

Dr. Zahir Ahmad Shah

Manipal Centre for Natural Sciences, Manipal Academy of Higher Education (MAHE)
Manipal, Karnataka, 576104, India

Date of Birth: 16 November 1988

Phone: +91-7780864526

Email: zahir.shah@manipal.edu



Research Interests

My research interest mainly involves the study of **broadband spectral and temporal properties of blazars** using multi wavelength data from various astrophysical observatories. This includes **developing analysis scripts** to automate the data reduction process and numerical codes to interpret the reduced data using theoretical emission models. I am also involved in obtaining the **analytical/numerical solutions of the particle distribution in the acceleration and cooling regions** for different scenarios of perturbations to the acceleration time-scale, cooling time-scale and injection rates. Besides this, I am also involved in characterization of temporal properties of longterm light curves of blazars.

Education

Ph.D.	University of Kashmir	2018
<i>Thesis: Understanding the Spectral and Temporal Behaviour of High Energy Blazars</i>		
<i>Supervisor: Prof. Naseer Iqbal</i>		
<i>Co-Supervisor: Dr. Sunder Sahayanathan</i>		
M.Phil.	University of Kashmir	2014
M.Sc. in Physics	University of Kashmir	2011
B.Sc.	University of Kashmir	2009
Higher Secondary	J&K State Board of School Education	2006
Secondary School	J&K State Board of School Education	2004

National Exam

› Qualified Joint CSIR-UGC National Eligibility Test (NET), All India Rank: 15.

Academic Positions

2018–2021	Post-Doctoral Fellow, Inter-University Centre for Astronomy and Astrophysics (IUCAA), Pune
2021–14 June 2026	INSPIRE Faculty, Central University of Kashmir
15 June 2026–Present	Assistant Professor, Manipal Centre for Natural Sciences, MAHE

Teaching Experience at University Level

- › Classical Mechanics
- › Quantum Mechanics
- › Relativistic Quantum Mechanics

- › Quantum Field Theory
- › Mathematical Physics
- › High Energy Astrophysics

Research Grants

- › Co-investigator, ISRO AstroSat data utilization project, Rs. 18.37 Lacs.
- › DST INSPIRE Faculty Fellowship of 77.40 lacs and research grant of Rs. 35 Lacs over five years.

PROFESSIONAL SERVICE

- › Served as a Peer-reviewer for the Nature Journals (Nature Communications.)
- › Served as a Peer-reviewer for the The Astrophysical Journal Supplement Series.
- › Served as a Peer-reviewer for the Monthly Notices of the Royal Astronomical Society.

Research Highlights

- › Broadband spectral and temporal data analysis techniques across multiple wavelengths.
- › Theoretical spectral modeling of blazars.
- › Time resolved spectral study of blazars.
- › Constraining High Energy (X-ray and gamma-ray) emission in Blazars.
- › Prediction of VHE Blazars for upcoming VHE telescopes.
- › Obtain constraints on EBL estimation using the VHE observations.
- › Numerical/Analytical solutions of Fokker-Plank equations
- › Statistical and simulation study of blazar light curves.

Research Expertise

- › Data analysis: Fermi-LAT, TACTIC, Swift-XRT, Swift-UVOT, NuStar, AstroSat SXT/LAXPC, UVIT, .
- › Theoretical SED modeling, numerical/analytical solutions for Fokker-Plank equation.
- › Computational/graphical skills: Python, FORTRAN, XSPEC, PYXSPEC, Gnuplot, Matplotlib.

Research Fellowships

- › Junior and Senior Research Fellowship (JRF & SRF), ISRO-RESPOND Project.
- › Post-Doctoral Fellowship, IUCAA.
- › INSPIRE Faculty Fellowship, DST.

Collaborations

- › University of Kashmir, ApSD BARC Mumbai, IUCAA Pune, IIA, IISER Mohali, Tezpur University, University of Southampton, NIT Rourkela, University of Nizwa

Accepted Proposals

- › *Principle Investigator (PI)* in “Investigating the Spectral Breaks and Thermal Emission of High Red shift Flat Spectrum Radio Quasars using AstroSat”, A03-77
- › *Principle Investigator (PI)* in “Investigating the broad band Spectral energy distribution Bl Lac blazars using AstroSat”, A04-094
- › *Principle Investigator (PI)* in “Multi-wavelength observation of FSRQ PMNJ1923-2104 during its active phase using AstroSat”, T03-018
- › *Co-Investigator (Co-PI)* in “Observation of Mrk 421 with AstroSat during the present flaring activity”, T01-218
- › *Co-Investigator (Co-PI)* in “Investigation the broadband spectral shape of Mrk 180 using multi-wavelength observation from AstroSat”, A05-064
- › *Co-Investigator (Co-PI)* in “X-ray/UV study of the high energy peaked blazar PKS 0352-686”, A05-202

Publications

1. Malik Zahoor, Akbar Sikandar, **Shah Zahir**, van Soelen B., “Exploring the Transitional Parameter Space of Blazars using Gamma-ray and X-ray Population Diagnostics”, *JHEAP*, Volume 56, February 2027, 100753, <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.jheap.2026.100753> (**Impact Factor-6.1**)
2. Peer Anjum, **Shah Zahir**, Akbar Sikandar, Maqbool Bari, Misra Ranjeev, “Probing the High-Energy Emission of the VHE-emitting Changing-Look Blazar B2 1420+32”, *ApJ*, 2026, accepted for publication, arXiv:2607.20375 (**Impact Factor-5.7**)
3. Akbar Sikandar, **Shah Zahir** et al, “A Possible Short-Timescale Optical Quasi-Periodic Oscillation in PKS 0805-07 from High-Cadence TESS Observations”, *JHEAP*, Volume 54, August 2026, 100693.
4. Manzoor Aaqib, **Shah Zahir** et al “Broad-band spectral and temporal study of OP 313 during its 2025 January very high energy flare”, *JHEAP*, Volume 53, July 2026, 100619 (**Impact Factor-6.1**)
5. Ahanger Sajad, **Shah Zahir** et al “Modeling the Time-variable Broadband Emission and Correlation Study of FSRQ S5 1044+71”, 2026, *ApJ*, 999, 170 (**Impact Factor-5.7**)
6. Nazir Zeeshan, Akbar Sikandar, **Shah Zahir** et al “Broadband Variability Analysis of FSRQ PKS 0402-362 with Indications of Quasi-Periodic Modulation”, 2026, *ApJ*, 998, 227 (**Impact Factor-5.7**)
7. Akbar Sikandar, **Shah Zahir** et al “Spectral state switching in Mrk421: Results from the AstroSat LAXPC/SXT observations”, *JHEAP*, Volume 53, July 2026, 100633 (**Impact Factor-6.1**)
8. **Shah Zahir**, et al, “Comprehensive variability analysis of blazars using Fermi light curves across multiple timescale”, *Phys. Rev. D*, 2025, 111, 123052 DOI: <https://doi.org/10.1103/61tz-jk8c> (**Impact Factor-5.3**)
9. Peer Anjum, Dar Athar A, **Shah Zahir** et al “Multiwavelength spectral and temporal analysis of VHE Blazar 1ES 1959+650: Tracing emission mechanisms across flux states”, *MNRAS*, 2026, 545, 3, staf2031, <https://doi.org/10.1093/mnras/staf2031> (**Impact Factor-5.2**)

10. Sikandar A., **Shah Zahir**, et al., “Indication for dual periodic signatures in PKS 0805-07 from multi-technique time series analysis”, *Phys. Rev. D (PRD)*, 2025, 112, 063061, <https://doi.org/10.1103/xyzfzv5> (**Impact Factor-5.3**)
11. Dar Athar, **Shah Zahir**, et al, “Unraveling the broadband spectrum of B2 1308+326: A clue to its high energy emission mechanism”, *New Astronomy*, 121 (2025) 102463, <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.newast.2025.102463> (**Impact Factor-2.1**)
12. **Shah Zahir**, “Multi-wavelength variability and broadband SED modeling of BL Lac during a bright flaring period MJD 59000-59943”, *MNRAS*, 2024, 527, 5140–5154 (**Impact Factor-5.2**)
13. Malik Zahoor, Akbar Sikandar, **Shah Zahir**, et al, “Statistical Insights into Flux and Photon Index Distributions of VHE FSRQs from Fermi-LAT Observations”, *MNRAS*, 2025, 539, 3, 2185–2201, <https://doi.org/10.1093/mnras/staf620> (**Impact Factor-5.2**)
14. Tantry Javaid, Sharma Ajay, **Shah Zahir**, Iqbal Naseer and Bose Debanjan “Study of multi-wavelength variability, emission mechanism and quasi-periodic oscillation for transition blazar S5 1803+784”, *JHEAP*, Volume 47, July 2025, 100372 (**Impact Factor-6.1**)
15. Ahanger Sajad, Sahayanathan Sunder, Sitha K. Jagan, **Shah Zahir**, Naseer Iqbal “Multi-wavelength analysis of FSRQ B2 1348+30B: Constraints on the jet power”, *JHEAP*, 2025, 47, 100400, <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.jheap.2025.100400> (**Impact Factor-6.1**)
16. Sikandar A., **Shah Zahir**, et al., “Probing spectral evolution and intrinsic variability of Mkn 421: A multi-epoch AstroSat study of X-ray spectra”, *JHEAP*, 2025, 45, 438-455 (**Impact Factor-6.1**)
17. **Shah Zahir**, et al. “AstroSat observation of the HBL 1ES 1959+650 during its October 2017 flaring”, *MNRAS*, 2021, 504, 5485–5495 (**Impact Factor-5.2**)
18. **Shah Zahir**, et al. “Unveiling the broadband spectral and temporal properties of PKS 0903-57 during its brightest flare”, *MNRAS*, 2021, 504, 416–427 (**Impact Factor-5.2**)
19. Tantry J., **Shah Zahir** et al. “Probing broadband spectral energy distribution and variability of Mrk 501 in the low flux state”, *JHEAP*, 2024, 44, 393–409 (**Impact Factor-6.1**)
20. Sikandar A., **Shah Zahir**, et al. “Insights into the Long-Term Flaring Events of Blazar PKS 0805-07: A Multi-Wavelength Analysis over the 2009-2023 Period”, *The Astrophysical Journal (ApJ)*, 2024, 977, 111 (**Impact Factor-5.4**)
21. **Shah Zahir**, et al. “On the determination of log-normal flux distributions for astrophysical systems”, *MNRAS*, Volume 496, Issue 3, August 2020, Pages 3348–3357 (**Impact Factor-5.2**)
22. **Shah Zahir**, et al. “Study on temporal and spectral behavior of 3C 279 during 2018 January flare”, *MNRAS*, 484, 3168-3179 (2019) (**Impact Factor-5.7**)
23. Manzoor A., **Shah Zahir**, et al. “Broadband spectral and temporal study of Ton 599 during the brightest January 2023 flare”, *MNRAS*, 2024 (**Impact Factor-5.2**)
24. **Shah Zahir**, et al. “Log-normal flux distribution of bright Fermi blazars”, *RAA*, 2018, 18, 11, 141 (**Impact Factor-2.8**)
25. **Shah Zahir**, et al. “Clues on high-energy emission mechanism from blazar 3C 454.3 during 2015 August flare”, *MNRAS*, 2017, Volume 470, Issue 3, p.3283-3299 (**Impact Factor-5.2**)
26. Khatoon R, **Shah Zahir**, et al “Study of long-term flux and photon Index distributions of blazars using RXTE observations”, *MNRAS*, 2020, 491, 2, 1934–1940 (**Impact Factor-5.2**)

27. Khatoon R, **Shah Zahir**, et al., “Correlations between X-ray spectral parameters of Mkn 421 using long-term Swift-XRT data”, *MNRAS*, 2022, 515, 3749–3759 (**Impact Factor-5.2**)
28. Rajput B., **Shah Zahir**, et al. “Correlation between optical and γ -ray flux variations in BL Lacs”, *MNRAS*, 2021, 504, 1772–1786 (**Impact Factor-5.2**)
29. Deka K., **Shah Zahir**, et al “The long-term X-ray flux distribution of Cygnus X-1 using RXTE-ASM and MAXI observations”, *JHEAP*, 31, 2021, 23-30 (**Impact Factor-6.1**)
30. Hota J., **Shah Zahir**, et al “Understanding the X-ray spectral curvature of MKN 421 using broadband AstroSat observations”, *MNRAS*, 2021, 508, 5921–5934 (**Impact Factor-5.2**)
31. M Zahoor, **Shah Zahir**, et al “Multiwavelength study of blazar 4C + 01.02 during its long-term flaring activity in 2014-2017”, *MNRAS*, 2022, 514, 4259-4269 (**Impact Factor-5.2**)
32. Dar A., **Shah Zahir**, et al “Can FSRQ 3C 345 be a very high energy blazar candidate?”, *MNRAS*, 2024, 527, 10575-10583 (**Impact Factor-5.2**)
33. M Zahoor, Sahayanathan, **Shah Zahir**, et al “Model-independent Redshift Estimation of BL Lac Objects through VHE Observations”, *MNRAS*, 2022, 511, 994–1003 (**Impact Factor-5.2**)
34. M Zahoor, Sahayanathan, **Shah Zahir**, et al “Very-high-energy flat spectral radio quasar candidates”, *MNRAS*, 2022, 515, 3, 4505-4513 (**Impact Factor-5.2**)
35. Xiongfei G., ..., **Shah Zahir**, et al “Exploring γ -Ray Flares in the Long-term Light Curves of CTA 102 at GeV Energies”, *The Astrophysical Journal Supplement Series*, 2022, 260:48 (29pp) (**Impact Factor-8.8**)
36. Manzoor A., **Shah Zahir**, et al “Understanding the very high energy γ -ray excess in nearby blazars using leptonic model”, *MNRAS*, 2023, 525, 3, 3533-3540 (**Impact Factor-5.2**)
37. Thekkoth A., Sahayanathan, **Shah Zahir**, et al “Understanding the broad-band emission process of 3C 279 through long term spectral analysis”, *MNRAS*, 2023, 526, 4, 6364-6380 (**Impact Factor-5.2**)
38. Khatoon R., Prince R, **Shah Zahir**, et al “Temporal and spectral study of PKS 0208-512 during the 2019–2020 flare”, *MNRAS*, 2022, 513, 611-623 (**Impact Factor-5.2**)
39. M Showkat, I Naseer, **Shah Zahir**, “Search of Astrophysical results with LIGO from the Science runs S1 to S5”, *JOURNAL OF ADVANCES IN PHYSICS* 6 (3)
40. Khan S, H. Abdullah; **Shah Zahir**, et al “The Fluctuation Theory, Critical Phenomena and Gravitational Clustering of Galaxies”, 2025, *Journal of Astrophysics and Astronomy*, 46, 2, 75 (**Impact Factor-1.6**)

ArXiv Preprints (Under Review):

41. Dar Athar A., **Shah Zahir** et al, “Signature of hadronic emission in gamma-ray spectrum of B2 1308+326”, <https://doi.org/10.48550/arXiv.2503.01583>
42. **Shah Zahir**, Akbar Sikandar, “Advance warning of γ -ray blazar flares from *Fermi*-LAT light curves: a strictly causal machine-learning backtest”, 2026, arXiv:2605.07680
43. Malik Zahoor, Akbar Sikandar, **Shah Zahir**, Rubab Seemin, “Indication of γ -ray Quasi-periodicity in GB6 J1037+5711 from Multi-technique Timing Analysis”, 2026, arXiv:2604.27461

44. Akbar Sikandar, **Shah Zahir**, “Characterizing Short-Timescale Optical Variability in Non-blazar Active Galactic Nucleus PKS0521–36 Using TESS”, 2026, arXiv:2603.22197

Conference Proceedings:

45. Khatoon R., **Shah Zahir** et al. “Flux Distribution Study of Mkn 421 with SPOL, RXTE and Fermi-LAT Telescopes, *Springer Proceedings in Physics* (Selected Progresses in Modern Physics: Proceedings of TiMP 2021), 2022, 125–133, DOI:10.1007/978-981-16-5141-0_13.
46. Deka K., **Shah Zahir** et al. “A study of the effects of histogram binning on the accuracy of finding flux distribution of X-ray binaries”, *Materials Today: Proceedings*, Volume 65, Part 5, 2022, Pages 2862-2864
47. Deka K., **Shah Zahir** et al. “Distribution of X-ray flux: RXTE-PCA Observation of Cygnus X-1”, *Materials Today: Proceedings*, Volume 65, Part 5, 2022, Pages 2862-2864.
48. Deka K., **Shah Zahir** et al. “Distribution of X-ray flux: RXTE-PCA observation of Cygnus X-1, Conference: Springer International Conference on Trends in Modern Physics 26-27 February 2021.
49. **Shah Zahir** et al “Understanding the evolution of X-ray spectral properties of blazars using broad-band AstroSat observations”, in 44th COSPAR Scientific Assembly, vol. 44, Jul. 2022, p. 2243.
50. J. Hota, **Shah Zahir** et al. “X-ray Spectral study of MKN 421 using Astrosat observation, in 44th COSPAR Scientific Assembly, vol. 44, Jul. 2022, p. 2245.
51. R. Khatoon, R. Misra, **Zahir Shah**, J. Hota, R. Gogoi, and A. Charan Pradhan, “Correlations between X-ray spectral parameters of Mkn 421 using long-term Swift-XRT data,” in 44th COSPAR Scientific Assembly, vol. 44, Jul. 2022, p. 2075.
52. Akbar Sikandar, **Shah Zahir**, Misra R., Iqbal N., Tantry J., “Long term correlation study between X-ray spectral parameters of Mkn 421 using AstroSat data”, 42nd Meeting of the Astronomical Society of India (ASI), 2024, P149.
53. Khatoon R., Jithesh V., Prince R., **Shah Zahir**, Misra R., Gogoi R., “Swift follow-up of the renewed flaring phase of blazar SBS 1150+497”, *The Astronomer’s Telegram*, 2019, ATel #13285.

Conference Presentations

➤ Oral Presentations/Resource person:

- International conference on *A Decade of AstroSat Observations: Science Outcomes and Future Prospects*, 30 January –1 February 2026, delivered contributed talk titled “Time resolved X-ray spectral study of Blazars with AstroSat: Probing underlying particle distribution”.
- Delivered IIA Astrophysics Seminar at Indian Institute of Astrophysics titled “Broadband Views of Blazars: Spectral and Temporal Probes of Relativistic Jets” on 27th January 2026
- *Astrosat & XPoSat Workshop 2024*, 28 February – 03 March 2024 at Providence Womens College Kozhikode, participated as resource person in the Workshop.
- *Advanced Astrosat Data Analysis Workshop 9-15 January 2023*, participated as resource person in the Workshop.

- *Himalayan Meet of Astronomers 2023 at IUST, Awantipora, 25-26 September 2023*, gave an invited talk on “Understanding Broadband Emission from Blazars” and chaired one scientific session on blazars.
- *4th National Conference on High Energy Emission from Active Galactic Nuclei*, gave an invited talk on “Temporal behavior of blazar light curves” and chaired one scientific session on blazars.
- *Introductory Workshop in Astronomy and Astrophysics, 18–19 December, 2021*, gave an invited talk on “Active Galaxies - Brightest Objects in the Universe”.
- *2nd China-India Workshop on High Energy Astrophysics, 6–10 December 2021*, gave an invited talk on “Understanding the evolution of X-ray spectral properties of blazars using broadband AstroSat observations”.
- *IUCAA Annual Seminars by Post-Doctoral Fellows - 2021*, gave a presentation on “Broadband Spectral and Temporal Study of Blazars”.
- *One day online meeting on Theoretical Aspects of High Energy Emission from AGN held on 06 July 2021*, gave an invited talk on “Time Resolved Spectral Study of 1ES,1959+650 using AstroSat Observations.
- *Astrophysical jets and observational facilities: National perspective, 05-09 April 2021*, gave a talk on “AstroSat observation of the HBL 1ES,1959+650 during its October 2017 flaring”.
- *Astronomy Group Seminar Programme, University of Southampton*, gave a seminar “Flux distribution study of Fermi bright blazars and simulated light curves” on Mon 14 Oct 2019.
- *4th National conference on Recent Trends in the Study of Compact Objects: Theory and Observation (RETCO-IV) 17 - 20 April 2019, IUCAA, Pune*, presented the work “Study on temporal and spectral behaviour of 3C 279 during 2018 January flare”
- *Growth Points in Physics (GPP-2017)*, UGC Sponsored National Seminar, held at University of Kashmir, Srinagar, 21-23 October 2017
- *High Energy Emission from Active Galactic Nuclei, 3rd national conference*, held at University of Calicut, Kerala, 28-30 November, 2017
- *Last Friday Talk at IUCAA on 25 January 2019*, presented the work “Multiwavelength study of 3C 279 during 2018 January flare”
- *Astronomical Society of India (ASI), 34th meeting* held at Kashmir University, Srinagar, 10-13 May, 2016

➤ Poster Presentations:

- *Young Astronomers Meet (YAM) 2017*, organized by the IUCAA during 11-15 September, 2017
- *IUCAA Science day foundation 2019*, organized by the IUCAA on 28 February, 2019

➤ Participations:

- *AstroSat Calibration Meeting*, Hosted by AstroSat Science Support Cell, IUCAA, Pune , 23-24 August 2022.
- *AstroSat Data analysis*, workshop organised by IUCAA, 13-16 Nov. 2017

- *AstroSat AO Proposal submission*, workshop organised by IUCAA, 13-14 July 2016
- *Extragalactic Relativistic Jets: Cause and Effect*, hosted by ICTS Bangalore, 12-20 Oct. 2015
- *Radio Astronomy School*, organized by National Center for Radio Astronomy (NCRA), Pune, 19-30 August 2013
- *Astronomical Techniques and Science with Virtual Observatories*, jointly organized by Department of Physics (Kashmir University) and Inter University Centre for Astronomy and Astrophysics (IUCAA, Pune), 23-26 Sep. 2013
- *High Energy Emission from Active galactic Nuclei (AGN)*, Jointly organised by department of physics (University of Kashmir), Board of Research in Nuclear Science (BRNS) BARC., and Indian Space Research Organisation (ISRO)., 7-9 Oct. 2013
- *Stellar Astrophysics*, jointly organized by Department of Physics (University of Kashmir, Srinagar) and Inter University Centre for Astronomy and Astrophysics (IUCAA), Pune, 24-26 Oct. 2011
- *High Energy Astrophysics*, winter School, organized by ApSD Bhaba Atomic Research Centre (BARC) at Mount Abu Rajasthan, 28 January to 3rd February, 2011
- *Participate in Online International workshop on VHE Data Analysis using Open Source Packages*, University of Kashmir, Srinagar, 1-3 February 2022.

References

- > **Prof. Naseer Iqbal**, Department of Physics, University of Kashmir, dni_phtr@kashmiruniversity.ac.in
- > **Prof. Ranjeev Misra**, IUCAA PUNE, rmisra@iucaa.in
- > **Prof. Debanjan Bose**, Department of Physics, Central University of Kashmir, Ganderbal debanjan.bose@cukashmir.ac.in